

Task 2

Read the text below. For questions (6—10) choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D). Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.

COPERNICUS, KING OF CRATERS

The best-known impact crater on the Earth is Meteor Crater. It is nearly a mile across and about 550 feet deep. To see it, you would have to drive far out into the desert in Arizona.

The Moon's best-known meteor crater is Copernicus. It is 58 miles in diameter and more than 2 miles from top to bottom. To see it, you just have to step outside and look at the Moon through binoculars.

You may have already noticed that the Moon's surface is a mix of bright and grey areas. The grey areas are lava plains. The largest and darkest lava plains are found along the left-hand side of the Moon. Using binoculars, look just to the left of the Moon's centre. You'll see a small bright spot against the gray. That's Copernicus.

Since the Moon doesn't have an atmosphere to protect it as the Earth has, tiny grains of space debris called meteoroids collide with the Moon constantly. This meteoroid «rain» wears down the lunar surface, creating a layer of dust. Meteoroids of the size of rocks and boulders strike the Moon less often, but they are more powerful. These rocks can produce craters measuring anywhere from a few feet to several miles across. On rare occasions, the Moon is hit by an object of the size of the one that carved out Copernicus. That object — either a rocky asteroid or an icy comet — was more than a mile in diameter.

Still, there are larger craters on the Moon, so why is Copernicus special? The answer is simple: because the crater faces the Earth directly, it looks nice and round, exactly the way everyone thinks a crater should look.

But what really makes Copernicus special is its halo of rays. These wispy streamers stretch outward in every direction. Like the crater itself, they are brightest when the Moon is full. Take a close look at these feather-like splashes.

When a big object blasts out a crater, the smallest particles travel farthest from the point of impact. This spray of rock then falls in a splash pattern onto the lunar surface. This material looks bright because it's made up of crushed and broken rock, which reflects light better than the dust-covered lava plain.

Over long periods of time, the constant bombardment by meteoroids darkens the rays and mixes them with the surface dust. Eventually, the rays disappear. Copernicus's rays are still bright because this crater is young. It's only 810 million years old. Many other large craters are nearly 4 billion years old.

The crater is named after the great astronomer Nicolaus Copernicus. In the 1800s, another astronomer studied this scar on the Moon's surface. He called it *the Monarch of the Moon*. Today, we can call it the king of craters.

(By Edmund A. Fortier)

- 6 We can see the biggest craters _____
 A on the Moon.
 B on the Earth.
 C in the desert.
 D in Arizona.

- 7 The surface of the Moon looks like _____
 A lakes and oceans.
 B the gloomy areas.
 C a mixture of dark and shiny areas.
 D small stars.

- 8 The Moon's dust layer has been created because of _____
 A the hits of big rocky asteroids.
 B the Moon's special atmosphere.
 C the collision of the Moon and the very small space pieces.
 D the comets hits.

- 9 Copernicus interests scientists because _____
 A it looks deep and square.
 B it is surrounded by a ring of light.
 C it's the oldest Moon crater.
 D its brightness remains always unchanged.
- 10 You can observe Copernicus _____
 A only when the Moon is full.
 B using an instrument designed to aid vision.
 C looking into the sky at daytime.
 D having no optical instruments.

Task 3

Read the text below. Match choices (A—H) to (11—16). There are two choices you do not need to use. Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.

INCREDIBLE TRIPS

- 11 **Thailand**
 If you have the time, this exotic nation has what it takes to please urban seekers as well as those who crave a more rural or nature-inspired vibe. We advise an 11-day itinerary spent visiting the cities of Bangkok, Phuket and Chiang Mai. Bangkok gives you the big-city bustle, Phuket is known for its white-sand beaches perfect for a romantic stroll, and Chiang Mai boasts the best of Thai culture, including the chance to ride elephants.
- 12 **Greek Isles**
 Soak in the natural beauty of this mystical region, tailor-made for honeymooners or any couple seeking the ultimate in romantic ambience. To experience several facets of the country, spend three nights in Athens, three in Santorini and another three in Crete, Nelson says. Here you can find many beautiful beaches, art galleries, fantastic food and friendly people. Oia, Santorini, has long been credited with the most beautiful sunsets in the world — with a good reason.
- 13 **Napa Valley**
 Romance and wine go hand in hand, and very few places in the world represent this duo better than Napa Valley. This world-famous wine region boasts some of the finest vintages, stunning scenery and haute cuisine locales. «With all the wineries and gorgeous views, the Napa Valley is an ideal destination for any couple while travelling domestically», said Sarah Nelson, project manager at Travel Leaders in Mesa, Arizona. «Another great part of Napa Valley is being able to take an afternoon hiking the region hand in hand».
- 14 **Hawaii**
 Learn how to surf, snorkel with exotic fish, tour historical sites and dine on celebrity chef cuisine on the island of Oahu. Home to the state's capital of Honolulu, the island offers picturesque beaches and waves on the east side and north shore, museums and art galleries, the famous snorkeling playground of Hanauma Bay and elegant restaurants. There's also the nightlife of Waikiki's bars and clubs, and if you want a dose of rural island life, unspoiled Kauai is a 30-minute plane ride away.
- 15 **Portland Food Tour**
 Foodie fans can appreciate seeing a city from a slightly different yet delicious perspective. Among the best are the Forktown Food Tours in Portland, Oregon, which offers culinary escapades through the city's most charming and historic neighbourhoods, including downtown, the Alphabet District and North Mississippi Avenue. These tours are locally driven and

combine city history along with small bites from five to seven hot spots. The Forktown Food Tour in Portland can be customized for just two guests to amp up the romance and fun.

16 Pacific Coast Highway

If you prefer to do some driving, motor along the most picturesque portions of California State Route 1. Start in Los Angeles and meander through worthy sites like Morrow Bay, tour the historic Hearst Castle and do a tasting at a vineyard or two en route to San Francisco. There are plenty of places to stop along the way and there is such beautiful scenery. It's just gorgeous and can easily be done in a week.

(By Georgann Yara)

You will visit this place if _____

- A** you dream about basking in each other's company during a walk.
- B** a sampling of blue waters and ancient sites appeals to you.
- C** you want to experience an animal ride.
- D** you long for a romantic week in a magical place.
- E** the ideal trip for you is aboard the ship.
- F** you are keen on active moving in a vehicle.
- G** a night in a restaurant is what you would like to experience.
- H** you are a real food and history gourmet.

USE OF ENGLISH

Task 5

Read the text below. For questions (23—32) choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D). Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.

FLOWER POWER

Electric field around flowers may help bees find nutritious blooms.

Flowers maintain small electric fields (23) _____ them. Bees can not only (24) _____ those fields, but they may also tell the insects which blooms are most likely (25) _____ a nectar reward, a team of scientists recently reported.

Flowers growing in the ground have a natural negative electric charge, notes Daniel Robert, a sensory biologist at the University of Bristol in England who worked on the new study. Their blooms (26) _____ electrons — the particles that carry negative charge — from the air to the ground. Throughout the air, positive electric charges abound, he explains. So bees, as they (27) _____, can become positively charged.

The scientists set up 30 (28) _____ metal disks covered with purple plastic to resemble flowers. Half of the disks were wired to create small electric fields, and half weren't. The disks with electric fields contained a sweet solution; the unwired ones held a bitter solution.

Scientists then sent in the bees and (29) _____ track of where they went. Toward the tail end of 50 visits to the «flowers», most bees had learned to find the sweet ones. Then the researchers unplugged the fake sweet flowers and tried the (30) _____ again. This time, when the fields were off, the bees never learned. Even after 50 visits, they found the sugar only about half the time — no better than if left to chance.

Robert and his (31) _____ studied the electric fields of real flowers, petunias, to better understand how bees and flowers might communicate. The scientists took measurements of a flower before and after a charged bee approached it. The flower's field reacted to the approaching bee with a small increase in strength. That electrical boost lingered for a little while after the bee had flown away.

That short-lived surge may help tell a different approaching bee that all of the flower's nectar has just been drunk. That bee would be able to sense the change in the flower's electric field, and move on to find a flower full of (32) _____.

Or, as Robert told *Science News*, the flower could signal to the bee: «I'm still pretty and smell nice, but... come back later».

	A	B	C	D
23	in	around	among	above
24	miss	overlook	detect	submit
25	to enjoy	to help	to advise	to offer
26	conduct	show	leave	attend
27	buzz in	buzz about	buzz off	buzz from
28	same	double	corresponding	identical
29	held	kept	took	gave
30	experiment	trial	check	test
31	fans	coordinators	co-workers	comrades
32	honey	sap	syrup	nectar

Task 6

Read the texts below. For questions (33—42) choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D). Write your answers on the separate answer sheet.

The term «business letters» (33) _____ to any written communication that begins with a salutation, ends with a signature and whose contents are professional in nature. Historically, business letters (34) _____ via postal mail or courier, although the Internet (35) _____ the way businesses communicate. There are many standard types of business letters, and each of them (36) _____ a specific focus: sales letters, order letters, complaint letters, inquiry letters, follow-up letters, letters of recommendation, acknowledgment letters and cover letters. When an employee plans (37) _____ his job, a Letter of Resignation is usually sent to his immediate manager giving him notice and letting him know when the last day of employment will be.

	A	B	C	D
33	refers	referred	referring	refer
34	are sent	will be sent	were sent	was sent
35	is changed rapidly	was rapidly changing	is rapidly changing	changing rapidly is
36	to have	had	have	has
37	left	to leave	leaving	have left

An essay is a short piece of writing. It (38) _____ from an author's personal point of view. The definition of an essay is vague, overlapping with those of an article and a short story.

In recent times, essays (39) _____ a major part of a formal education. Secondary students are taught structured essay formats to improve their writing skills, and essays are often used by universities in selecting applicants. In both secondary and tertiary education, essays are used (40) _____ the mastery and comprehension of material. Students are asked to explain, comment on, or assess a topic of study in the form of an essay.

Academic essays are usually (41) _____ than literary ones. They may still allow the presentation of the writer's own views, but this is done in a logical and factual manner, with the use of the first person often (42) _____.

	A	B	C	D
38	is often written	is writing	often was write	was often written
39	become	becoming	have become	became
40	judge	judging	was judged	to judge
41	formal	more formal	the most formal	formally
42	discouraged	discouraging	discourage	to discourage